Seattle
Police Department

DATE: April 15, 2025

TO: Sara Nelson, President, Seattle City Council

FROM: Brian Maxey, SPD Chief Operating Officer

SUBJECT: Semiannual and Quarterly Reports on SPD Recruitment and Retention Efforts

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Ordinance 127026, adopted in May 2024, created a Recruitment and Retention program within the Seattle Police Department. It also requires SPD to report semiannually/quarterly on the City's latest recruitment and retention efforts.

Please refer to the attached detailed reports responsive to the data request. Attachments A through C are semiannual reports and include data from July to December 2024:

- Attachment A – Data on SPD and PSCSC applicant contacts
- Attachment B – PSCSC data on civil service exam metrics
- Attachment C – Overview of programs to increase diversity

Attachments D through G are quarterly reports and include data from October to December 2024:

- Attachment D – Pre-Exam survey results for both entry-level and lateral applicants
- Attachment E – Results of a survey of police officer applicants who did not schedule and/or complete all required exam components
- Attachment F – Backgrounding timeline
- Attachment G – Summary of results from officer exit interviews and surveys that can inform retention strategies

Attachment A

SPD and PSCSC Contact with Applicants

January 2025

Introduction

The Seattle Police Department has an internal Recruiting Team of four (4) employees, both sworn and civilian. The Recruiting Cadre, an auxiliary team of Department employees, also lends support to recruitment efforts. Working in collaboration with the Seattle Police Department Background Investigations Team and the City of Seattle Fire & Police Exam Unit, the current recruiting process engages prospective candidates for police officer through the variety of strategies described herein. This high-touch recruiting model is essential for building strong relationships, ensuring a positive and successful experience throughout the recruitment process, and hiring quality candidates.

The contacts noted herein represent the timeframe between July 2024 – December 2024.

Contacts with Public Safety Civil Service Commission (PSCSC)

Upon application, candidates are asked if they would like to speak with an SPD recruiter. The PSCSC sends weekly reports to SPD Recruiting with the names, email addresses, and phone numbers of all candidates who selected "yes" to this question. 91% of applicants opt to speak to an SPD recruiter.

As of 11/1/2024, candidates are further asked upon application if they would like to be contacted by a member of the PSCSC Exam Unit. Those who opt in to speak with PSCSC staff are contacted individually using their preferred outreach method (phone, text, email). Between 11/1/2024 and 1/2/25, PSCSC staff conducted individualized outreach to 576 applicants. 89% of applicants opt to speak to PSCSC staff.

In addition, candidates receive 5 standard messages through the exam cycle:

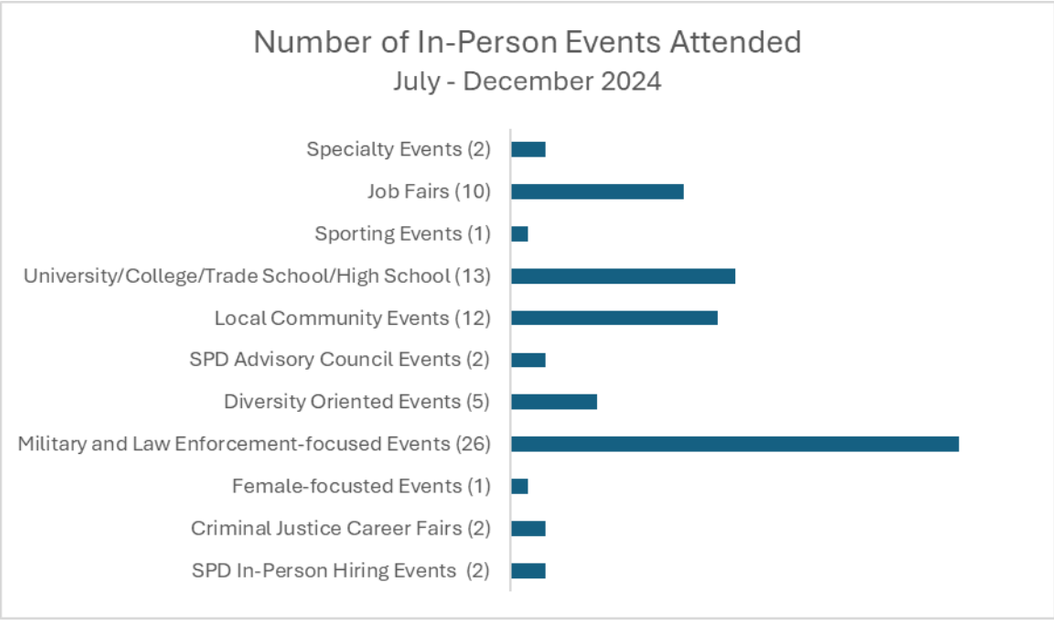
1. Automated **email confirmation** that application was received
2. **Welcome email** with details on the exam and hiring processes
3. **"Chief's Letter"** - Thanks candidates for their interest in serving Seattle and provides info on the exam and hiring processes.
4. **Text Message** - Thanks candidates for applying and encourages them to register for an applicant workshop
5. **Exam Result Notification** – Candidates are notified if they passed or failed and instructed on next steps

All emails contain links to speak with a recruiter and register for an applicant workshop. Furthermore, all information provided in the candidate communications is also accessible in the job bulletin, which is available to candidates at any time. Contact information is provided in every email. Candidates can call exam staff or respond directly via email at any time. Exam staff engage in individualized contact with applicants and test takers daily.

Contacts with SPD Recruiting

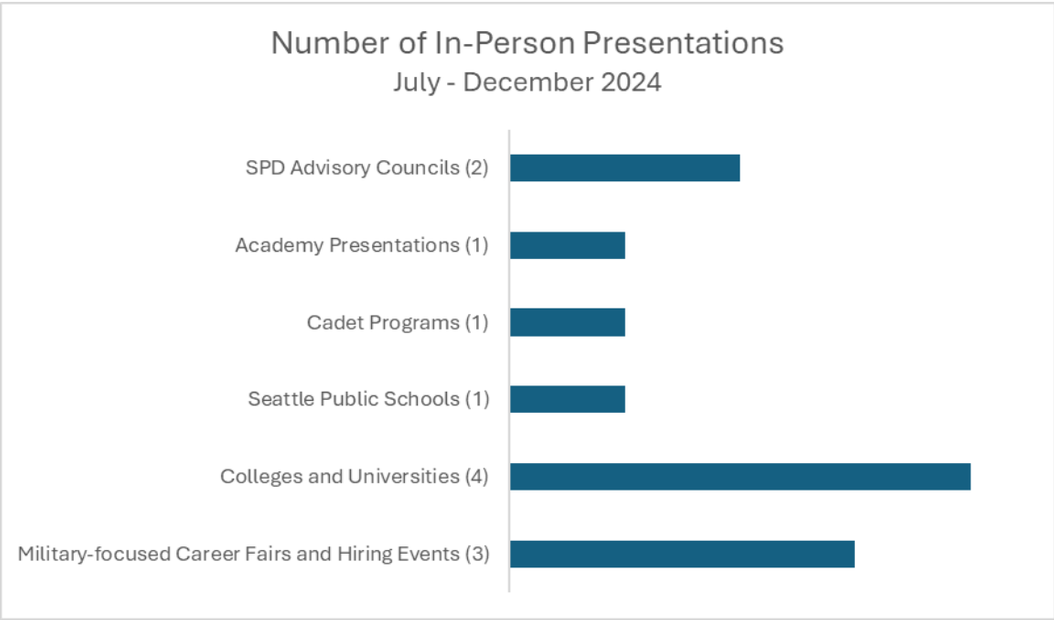
IN-PERSON EVENTS:

In-person events offer the perfect opportunity to engage candidates interested in applying, facilitate interaction with the community at large, and to lend a sense of what SPD is about. Focused recruitment to historically underrepresented groups and women remains a top priority and part of the overall recruitment strategy. A sampling of in-person events is included on the last page of this section.



IN-PERSON PRESENTATIONS

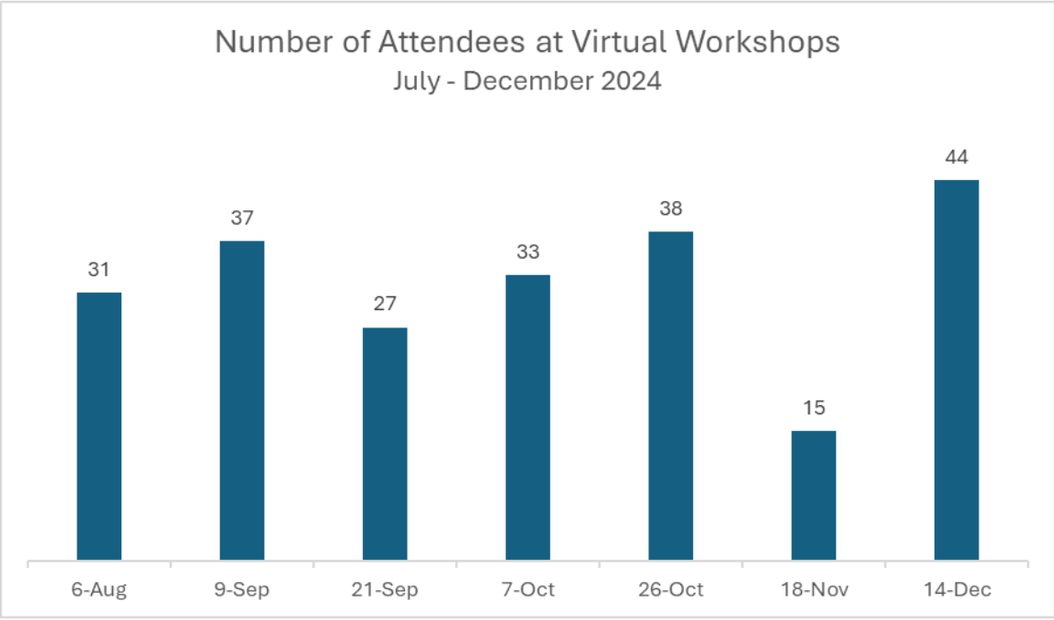
Proactive, face-to-face interactions facilitate more direct and spontaneous discussions, make participants feel more comfortable asking questions, and ultimately allow the presenter to better engage with candidates interested in applying. The Recruiting Team has created and delivered multiple presentations over the past six (6) months and will continue to prioritize and seek out these opportunities. A sampling of in-person presentations is included on the last page of this section.



VIRTUAL WORKSHOPS

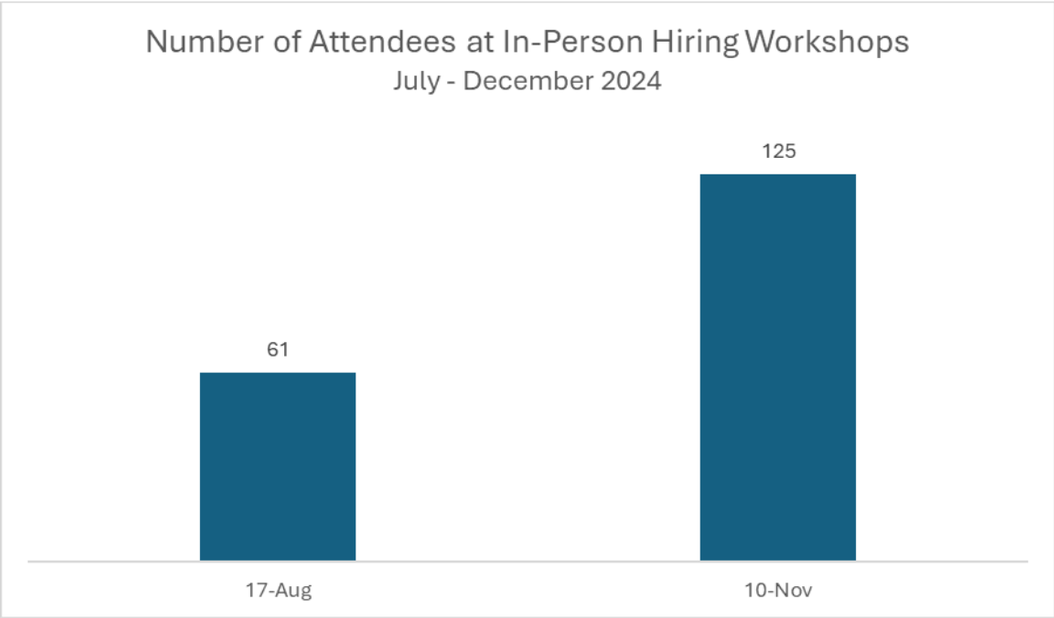
Virtual workshops provide prospective candidates with the opportunity to connect with the SPD Recruiting Team, the City of Seattle Fire & Police Exam Unit, and to gain valuable insight into the testing and hiring process from the convenience of their own homes, office spaces, and/or state of residence. Virtual

workshops were held August 6, September 9 and 21, October 7 and 26, November 18, and December 14; attendance numbers are charted below. The workshops have consistently had a positive impact in helping candidates navigate the hiring process and will continue to be held twice monthly in 2025.



IN-PERSON HIRING WORKSHOPS

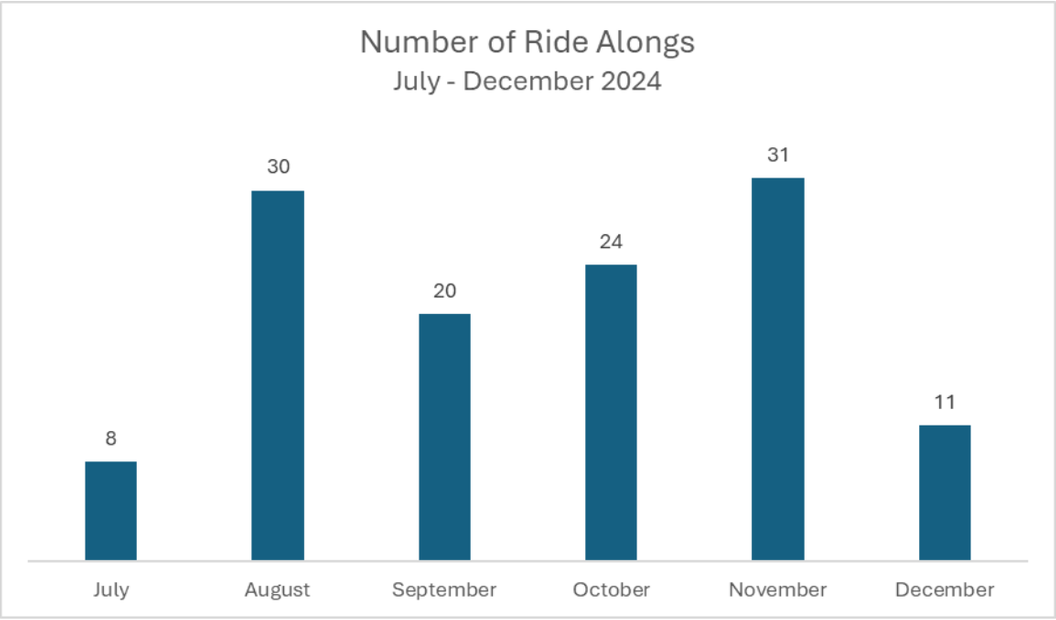
The Recruiting Team hosted In-Person Hiring workshops in August and November. The events were highly successful, and attendance doubled from August to November. The Workshops permit the participants to get an understanding of what policing is all about and include breakout sessions with SPD specialty units; presentations on the testing, hiring, and academy processes; question-and-answer sessions; the opportunity to complete the physical agility test (PAT); and a short Ride Along. SPD Interim Chief Sue Rahr also spoke to attendees about her journey into policing. The next Workshop is scheduled for March 1, 2025, and subsequent workshops will occur quarterly throughout 2025.



RIDE ALONG PROGRAM

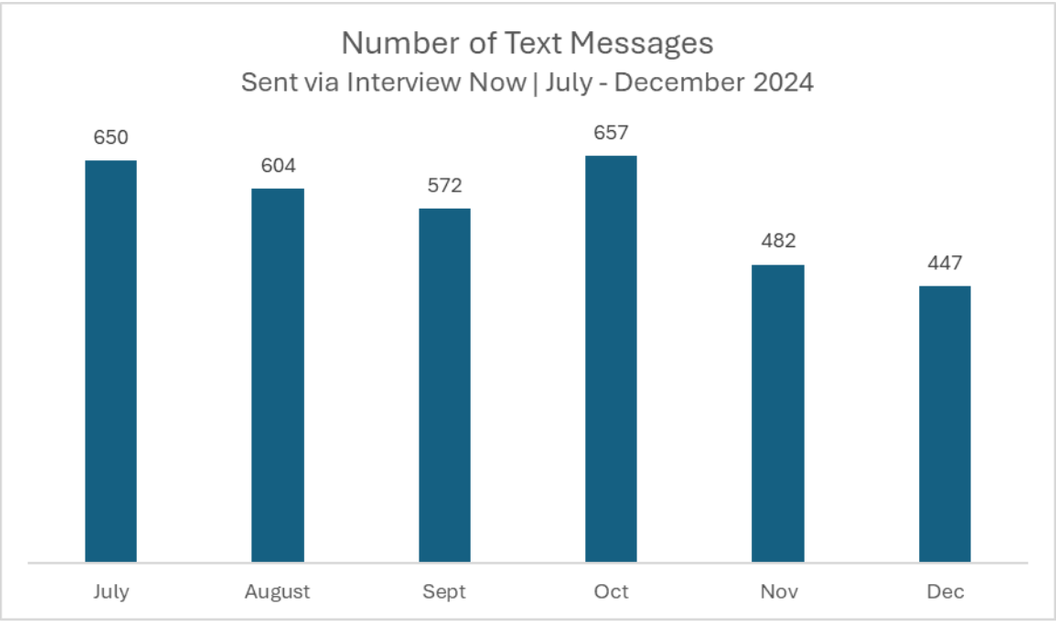
The Ride Along Program allows an observer to accompany an officer during an assigned shift. The Seattle Police Department recognizes the value in allowing firsthand observation of daily police operations and looks to provide a safe and informative experience. The Ride Along tends to be **THE** selling point to get candidates to commit to SPD. The capacity of the Ride-a-long program has been improved, and the team is

able to proactively offer ride-a-longs. The precincts also coordinate Ride Along requests, independently from the Recruiting Team; those statistics are also captured within this chart.



EMAIL AND TEXT MESSAGES

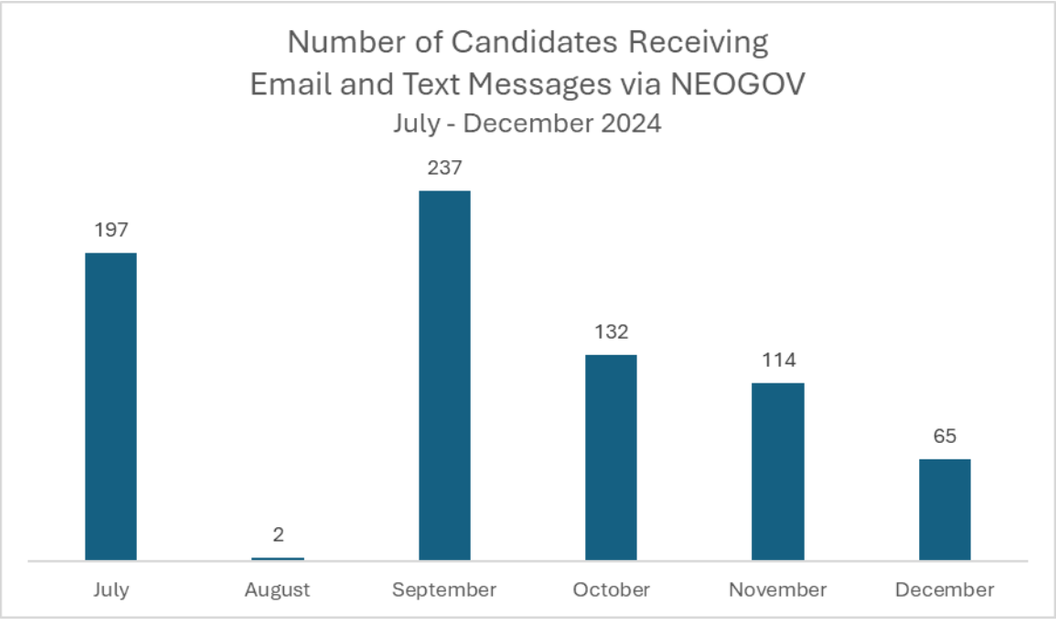
Interview Now is a cutting-edge recruiting platform that streamlines communication, enhances candidate engagement with law enforcement agencies, and facilitates the high-touch experience expected by today's applicants. Both the Recruiting Team and Cadre employ this technology to send text messages to prospective applicants and candidates in real-time, facilitate rapid responses, and provide timely feedback and updates.



In November 2024, the Background Investigations Team began sending text messages through eSOPH. Candidates who opt-in to the messaging service receive reminders of upcoming requirements and deadlines. Statistical charting of eSOPH messages will be included in subsequent installments of this reporting.

NEOGOV is the platform used to send standardized text messages and emails to all applicants. As part of their standard process, the Background Investigations Team sends (1) text message and five (5) standard

email messages (an increase from 3 in the first half of 2024) through NEOGOV, to eligible applicants. Both email and text messages sent through NEOGOV are charted below.



In addition, applicants may receive personalized email communications from the Recruiting Team, Background Investigations Team, or the Recruiting Cadre. Messages sent outside of NEOGOV, eSOPH, or Interview Now are not quantified.

PHONE COMMUNICATION

The Recruiting Team, Background Investigations Team, and the Recruiting Cadre collaborate to place phone calls to prospective candidates and to applicants in the pre-employment screening process. Applicants who opt-in for contact and candidates on the eligibility roster receive an introductory phone call (at a minimum). More than 1,000 calls have been placed YTD. In addition, the group consistently fields phone calls to respond to general inquiries, provide clarifying information, and offer support or assistance with the hiring process. These calls are too numerous to quantify.

PHYSICAL AGILITY TEST (PAT) SCHEDULING, TRAINING ASSISTANCE, AND COMPLETION

The Recruiting and Background Investigations Teams generate and send email communications to applicants with reminders about timelines for completing the PAT, resources available for training and preparation, and the option of completing a virtual PAT with a Team member. In the past five (5) months, members of the SPD Recruiting team have personally overseen over 44 PAT's. Applicants are extended access to the Train Heroic APP and to The Physical Ability Test (PAT) to promote success with this stage of the process. In mid-October, SPD began hosting bi-monthly PAT's. This has streamlined and simplified the process with attendance as high as 50 candidates per session. Due to the volume of communication with PAT participants and the move to a two-week testing cycle, it is difficult to quantify the impact of these changes during this reporting cycle.

Sampling of In-Person Events and Presentations

In-person events: Othello Park, Backpack for Kids, Seafair, Horn of Africa, CID Celebration, SeaMar Fiestas Patrias, Filipino Community Meet the Officers, mid-Autumn night market, Kitsap County Fair, Seahawks vs Cardinals game, Coffee with a Cop West Seattle, JBLM Brown bag twice a month, PX Recruiting, Hire our Heros, Bangor Brown Bag quarterly, Wake Tech Academy visit, Law Enforcement Hiring Expo, WSU Veteran's Lunch, Naval Base Kitsap Hiring, Battle of the Badges, Snohomish county Regional Job & Resource

Fair, several Worksource Job Fairs, Community Job Fair, Central Sound Regional Job Fair, 3 days at Trades & Hiring Fair Tacoma, Unity Effort Sequim (first responder festival), Podcast, Pierce College EMT classroom visit, Bates College EMT classroom visit, Duke University Student Athlete Career Fair, WSU career fair, University of Idaho Career Fair, St. Martin's Job Fair, Lewis and Clark College job fair, CWU Career Fair, Lake WA Technical institute Job Fair, Lamar University, UNCF Garfield High School College & Career Fair, SPD Run Workshops, Urban Resources League Fair, LatinXPO Career Fair, UNCF College and Career Fair, Worksource LatinX in Texas, HBCU Expo Garfield High School, Women in Law and Justice Panel, Central, LGBTQ Advisory Council

In-person presentations: Academy presentation to Bangor Naval Base presentation, Meeting with WSU police cadets, Presentation to EMT classes at Pierce College, Bates College, WSU Engagement with Students

Attachment B

PSCSC Data for Bi-Annual City Council Report

January 2025

Applicant and Test Taker Data

Metric	Current Status	Notes
# Entry Applicants/day (2024)	**ENTRY LEVEL** **TOTAL APPLICATIONS: 4,115** Avg per day: 11.88 **TOTAL PASSED MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS: 3,946** Avg per day: 11.40	Please note that for lateral applications, there is a substantial difference between the number of total applications and the number of applications that passed the minimum qualifications audit. This is because many entry level candidates mistakenly apply for the lateral classification. These applicants are advised to re-apply for the entry level exam. If applicable, they are also notified of the criteria and instructions for entering the hiring process as an "exceptional entry" candidate (i.e., a candidate who has prior law enforcement experience but does not currently meet the minimum qualifications for the lateral classification).
	LATERAL **TOTAL APPLICATIONS: 216** Avg per day: 0.58 **TOTAL PASSED MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS: 100** Avg per day: 0.26	
Apply-to-eligible rate (2024)	28%	Highest reported apply-to-eligible rate in over 10 years
% of applicants who participate in exam (2024)	40%	Increased from 34% in 2023
% of applicants by type (2024)	**Entry Level:** 98% **Lateral:** 2%	
Exam pass rate by applicant type (2024)	**Entry Level:** 70% **Lateral:** 100% (written exam), 93% (oral board interview)	
Pre-exam survey metrics	See attached reports	
Post-exam survey metrics	See attached report	

Comparison with Regional and National Comparator Agencies

City	Number of Applicants	Number of Exam Participants	Passed Written Test	Notes
Seattle	4,115 Total Applications 3,750 Unique Applicants*	1,655	1,163	Time period is 2024 Historical and current exam data is available at: https://www.seattle.gov/public-safety-civil-service-commission/exam-and-registers/exams-data *Candidates often re-apply multiple times per year. "Unique Applications" reflects the number of distinct individuals who applied in 2024, while "Total Applications" reflects the total number of applications received.
"West Coast Seven" Cities				
Long Beach	NA	190	50	Time period is 11/4/23 - 11/5/24.
Oakland	NA	NA	NA	Records provided weren't responsive
Portland, OR	1,447	NA	NA	Time period is 1/1/24-12/12/24. 63 applicants were lateral police officers
Sacramento	1,129	NA	NA	Time period is 7/1/23-6/30/24
San Diego	3,571	1,309	829	Time period is 9/1/23-8/1/24
San Francisco				Pending response
San Jose	2,197	NA	NA	Time period is 7/1/23-6/30/24
Comparable Washington Cities				
Spokane	132	132	132	1/17/24-12/11/24 (all applicants must have passed written exam, 70% pass rate)
Vancouver	NA	NA	NA	City does not have records/does not track this information
Tacoma	1,575	NA	627	Time period is 7/1/23-7/1/24

Methodology:
With the exception of Sacramento, police application and exam data was not publicly available. CIV staff submitted public disclosure requests and received the above information from jurisdictions; some requests are still outstanding. Spokane, Vancouver and Tacoma are Washington state comparables chosen for their size and proximity to larger urban areas. Please note that agencies vary in their testing processes and how they define "applicants". We have limited information regarding how each jurisdiction's application and testing process compares to Seattle's.

Attachment C

Programs to Increase Department Diversity

January 2025

Introduction		

In January 2024, SPD established an employee-led, interest-based, cross-rank and position internal 30x30 Initiative Workgroup. The Workgroup continues to move forward with research and development on new initiatives/programs and remains committed to exploring viable options to existing challenges.

Strategies	Proposed Programs/Areas of Focus	Notes
New and Innovative Programs consistent with the 30x30 Initiative	**Childcare Initiative**	**Challenge:** Childcare is a significant barrier for recruiting and retaining a diverse, healthy, and community-oriented law enforcement workforce **Vision:** a. Establish childcare centers and increase childcare options for children of SPD employees b. Provide round-the-clock childcare services to accommodate varying shift schedules c. Offer flexible drop-off and pick-up times to accommodate irregular work hours **Completed:** a. Contract finalized with Marie Keller, of Imagine Institute, to evaluate childcare options for SPD **In progress:** a. Imagine Institiute is preparing a report and recommendations (completion expected by early Spring) b. Contract scope calls for Imagine Institute to conduct informational gathering forums
	Mentorship Programs	**Vision:** a. Raise the bar on professional development b. Mentorship options for all sworn employees **Completed:** a. City of Seattle Career Quest Program identified as the mentorship platform b. Consultation with San Francisco Police Department (SFPD) to explore their experience and success with

		Career Quest, and discuss best practices, challenges, and upcoming developments **Under development:** a. Employee wants/needs assessment survey b. Program structure options • Flash Mentorship • Traditional Mentorship c. Building the base of Mentors d. Pilot program for sworn employees
	Exploration of flexible shift options and shift rotations	**Vision:** Shift flexibility **Under development:** a. Dialogue on job sharing, flexible shifts options, and shift rotations b. Revamping and restructuring of Part-Time Officer Program
	Expanded awareness of existing employee benefits **Benefit examples:** Career Quest Programs – job readiness workshops, career coaching, scholarships, mentorship programs (Flash Mentorship, Traditional Mentorship); professional development and training opportunities; CityU First Responders tuition discount program; SPD Part-time Officer Program; employee leave options - PPL, FML (City and State); accommodations; et cetera	**Vision:** Expand awareness and internal visibility of existing employee benefits and innovations under development **Completed:** a. APPSPACE (launched by Performance Analytics and Research team in July 2024). Ongoing broadcasts on APPSPACE: a. 30x30 Workgroup email blasts b. Female-focused recruiting videos on display • SPD One Seattle: New Voices, New Perspectives • SPD One Seattle: Women in Law Enforcement • SPD One Seattle • New recruits bring hope and change to Seattle police force amid staffing improvements **Under development:** a. Creation of additional announcements to inform of available City benefits b. Creation of additional announcements to inform of 30X30 and generate support c. Expanded information sharing through SPD Notices, SPD SharePoint HR page, and SPD Recruiting SharePoint page
	Return to work (RTW) post-childbearing challenges	**Vision:** Ensure support to new parents upon RTW **Completed:**

		a. Upgrade of existing lactation spaces (comfort-related upgrades, ensuring appropriate privacy, seating, sanitation, and refrigeration space) **Under development:** a. New parent focus group b. Exploration of flexible shift and schedule options c. Awareness and understand of available options • Lactation accommodation • SPD Part-time Officer Program
	Female oriented initiatives	**Vision:** Female oriented initiatives to increase recruiting and retention **Completed:** Female-focused recruiting, support, and career highlight videos created by the Public Affairs Unit • SPD One Seattle: New Voices, New Perspectives • SPD One Seattle: Women in Law Enforcement • SPD One Seattle **Upcoming in February 2025:** a. "Gear Up for Change," forum with Avient, to provide feedback on PPE fit for female officers **In progress:** a. Selection of an Ad marketing firm with a clear proposal on engaging female applicants (refer to Revised recruitment strategies section) **Under development:** a. Virtual Ride Along featuring female officers b. New hire survey to gauge career aspirations and guide mentorship options c. Ensuring female-specific needs are met d. Appropriate equipment and/or equipment accommodations e. Female-specific and all female training options, to include defensive tactics f. SPD organized and led Physical Agility Test (PAT) Readiness Training g. Female-specific leadership, tactical, and promotional training h. "Zero tolerance" EEO practices

		i. Career longevity coaching j. Mentor - Mentee pairing k. Review of existing and future advertising to ensure gender neutrality
	Expanded support systems for women in law enforcement	**Vision:** Expand support for women in law enforcement **Under development:** a. Professional and promotional development groups b. Interdepartmental mobility (e.g. - Sponsorship of women for career advancement, specialty assignments, and promotional assignments) c. Affinity groups
	Language in advertising (specific to recruiting and hiring female officers)	**Vision:** Implement best practices endorsed by the 30x30 Initiative **In progress:** Implementing RTI International's Best Practices for Optimizing Law Enforcement Job Descriptions to Recruit Diverse Candidates
	Revised recruitment strategies to reach under-represented groups	**Vision:** Increase outreach **Completed:** a. Increased in-person recruiting presentations • Colleges/Universities • College athletes • High schools • EMT programs b. Female-focused marketing and hiring campaigns c. Recruitment campaigns to the various and diverse SPD Advisory Councils d. Engaging family and community **In progress:** a. Engaging law enforcement specific recruitment firm to create and produce new marketing content (videos, photos) b. Selection of an Ad marketing firm with a clear proposal on how to engage female, lateral, and underrepresented candidates
	DOD SkillBridge Program	**Vision:** Service members gain valuable work experience through specific industry training during the last 30 to 270 days of service, facilitating the hiring process to become Seattle Police Officers

		Completed: a. Final vetting by City labor law attorneys b. Outreach to eligible candidates c. Four (4) candidates have been hired **In progress:** a. Continuing proactive outreach
	Assessment of special assignment and on-loan assignment selection process	**Vision:** Comprehensive review and assessment of the current process **In progress:** Taskforce Career Advancement Meetings and dialogue organized by RSJI Change Team

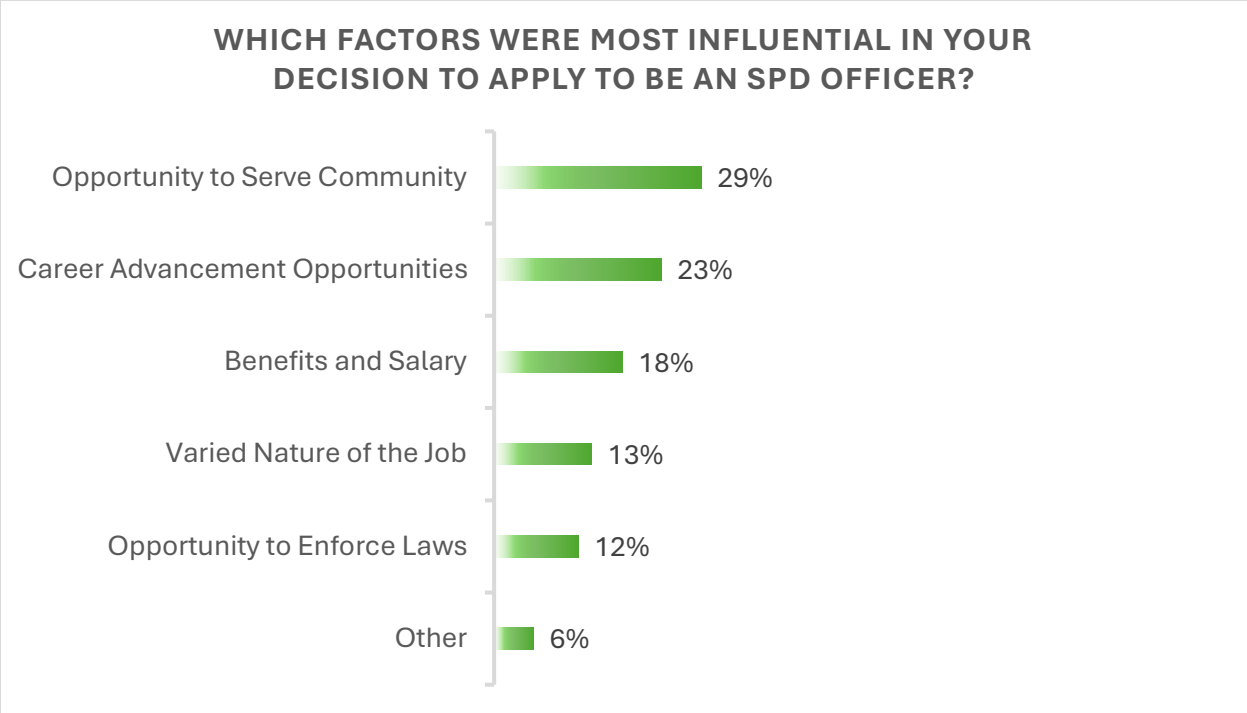
Attachment D

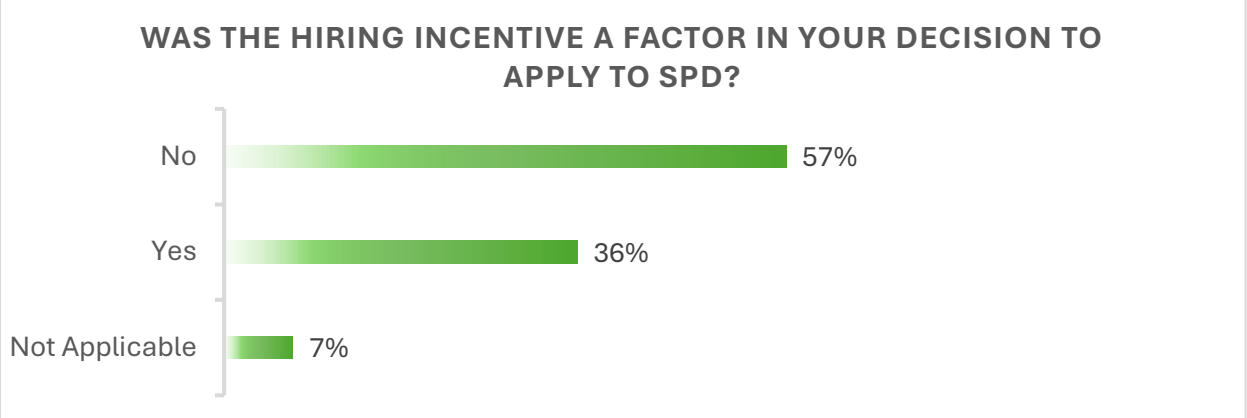
Entry Level Police Officer

Candidate "Pre-Exam Survey"/Supplemental Application Question Report

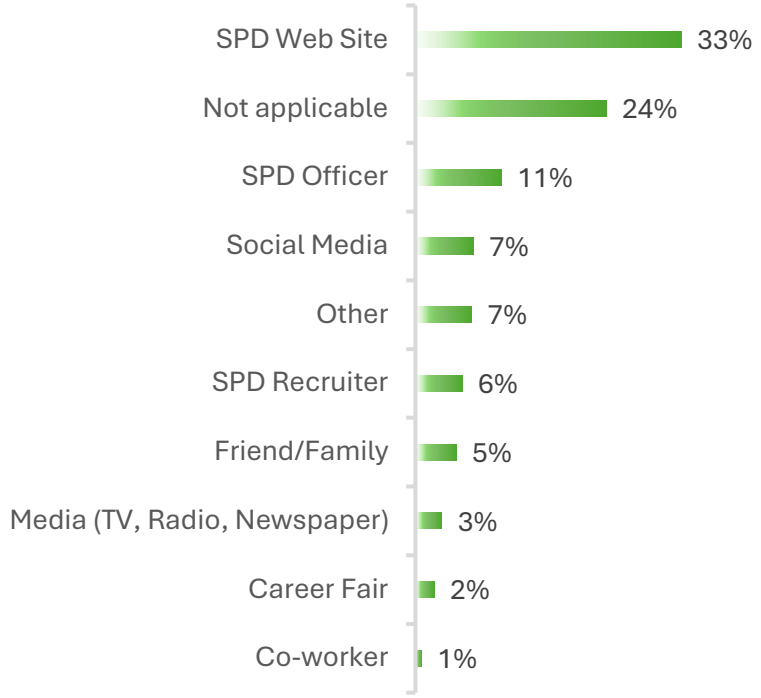
January 2025

The following graphs reflect data from all 2024 entry-level police officer applicants.

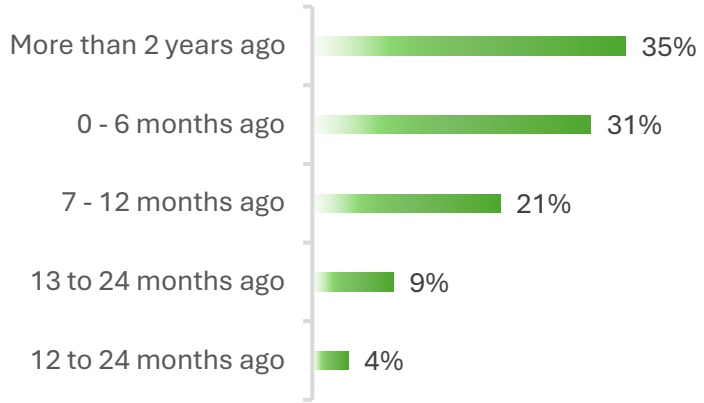




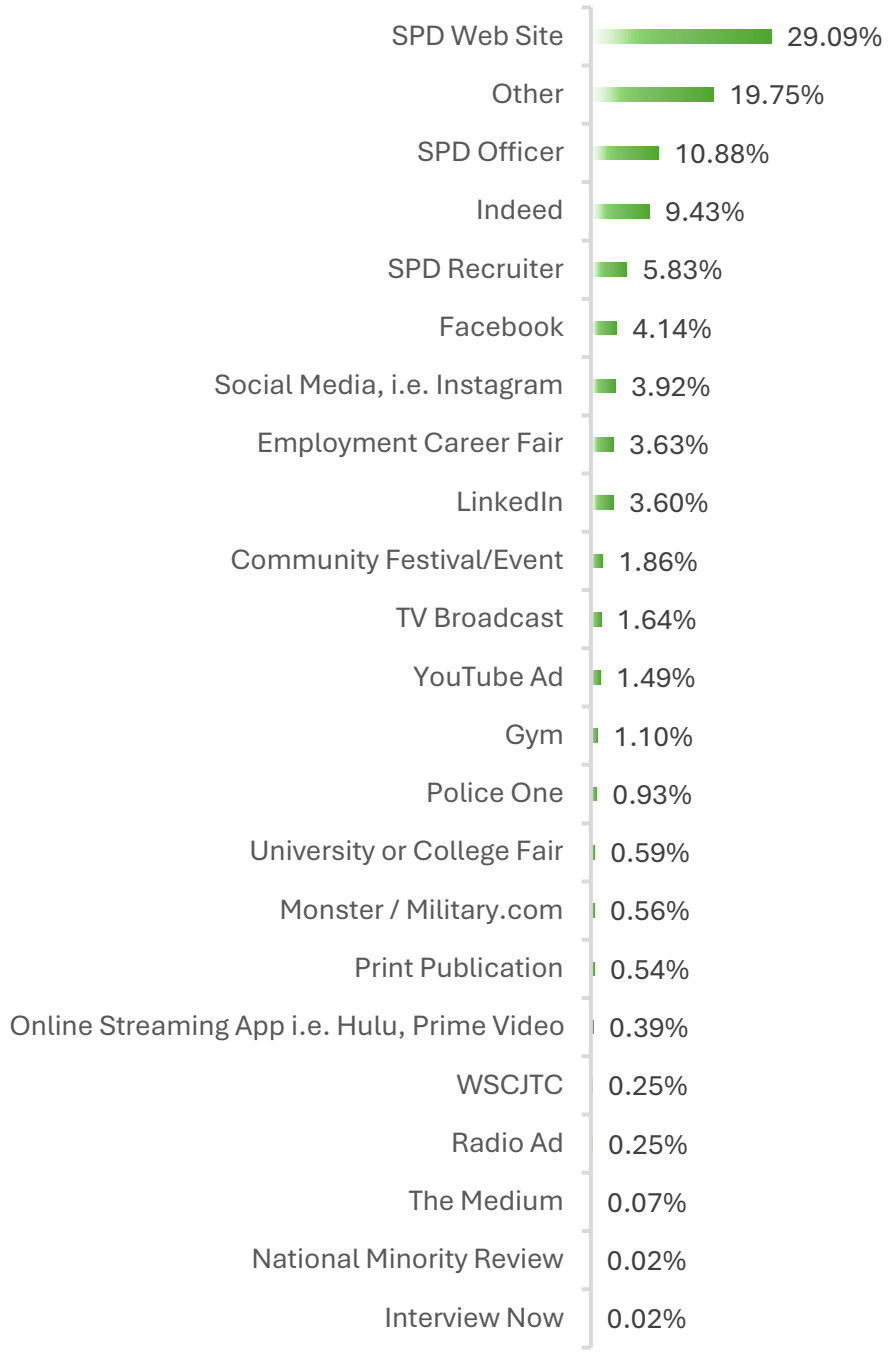
IF THE HIRING INCENTIVE WAS A FACTOR IN YOUR DECISION, HOW DID YOU HEAR ABOUT THE HIRING INCENTIVE?



HOW RECENTLY DID YOU DECIDE TO PURSUE A CAREER IN POLICING?



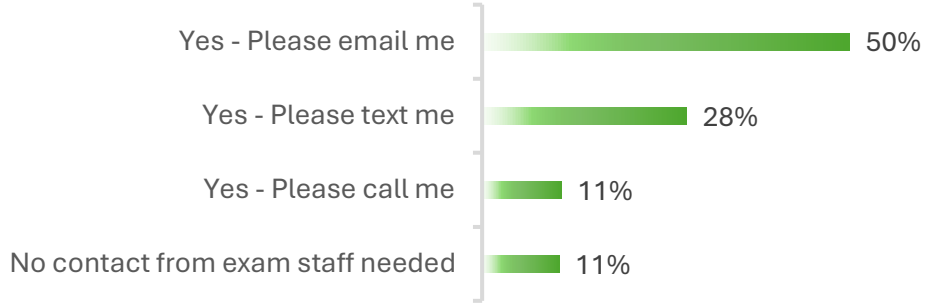
HOW DID YOU HEAR ABOUT THIS OPPORTUNITY WITH SPD?



WOULD YOU LIKE TO BE CONTACTED BY THE SEATTLE POLICE DEPARTMENT (SPD) TO LEARN MORE ABOUT THE HIRING PROCESS, THE DAY-TO-DAY WORK, AND/OR CAREER PATH OPPORTUNITIES?



WOULD YOU LIKE TO BE CONTACTED BY PUBLIC SAFETY CIVIL SERVICE EXAM STAFF TO DISCUSS THE CIVIL SERVICE TESTING PROCESS?



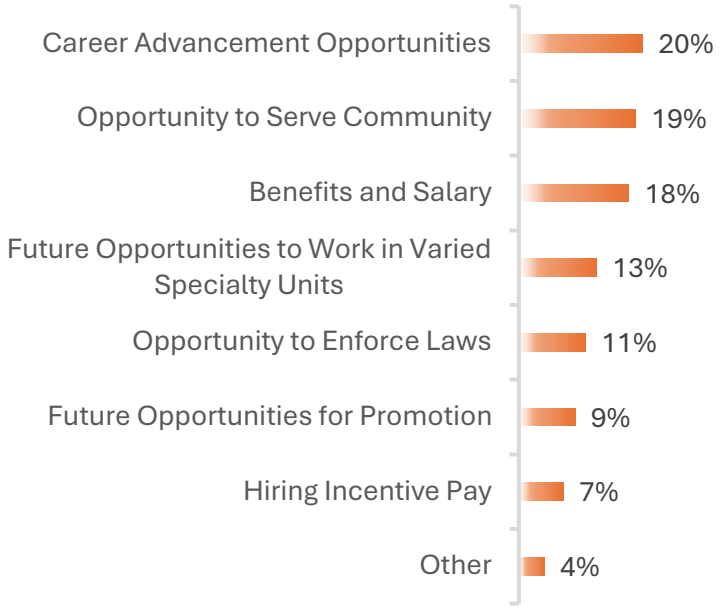
Lateral Police Officer

Candidate "Pre-Exam Survey"/Supplemental Application Question Report

January 2025

The following graphs reflect data from all 2024 lateral police officer applicants.

WHICH FACTORS WERE MOST INFLUENTIAL IN YOUR DECISION TO APPLY TO BE AN SPD OFFICER?

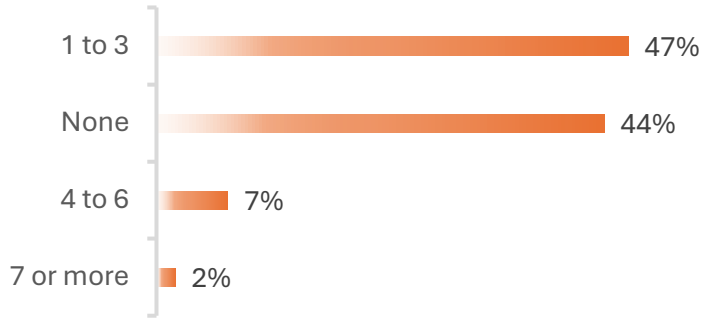


PRIOR TO THIS APPLICATION, WERE YOU AWARE THAT SEATTLE OFFERS A 50K HIRING INCENTIVE FOR LATERAL ENTRY OFFICERS?*



NOTE: This question was updated on 11/11/2024 to reflect the increase in lateral hiring incentive pay from 30k to 50k.

TO HOW MANY OTHER JURISDICTIONS ARE YOU CURRENTLY APPLYING?



HOW DID YOU HEAR ABOUT THIS OPPORTUNITY WITH SPD?



Attachment E

City of Seattle

Entry Police Officer Exam Applicant Survey Report



JANUARY 2025

Seattle Public Safety Civil Service Commission

Public Safety Exams Unit

Seattle

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Introduction

Purpose

Pursuant to State Law and City Ordinance, the Public Safety Exams Unit develops and administers merit-based entry-level and promotional exams under direction of the Public Safety Civil Service Commission (PSCSC) and on behalf of the Seattle Police Department (SPD) and Seattle Fire Departments (SFD).

In 2023, the city received 1,948 entry level police officer applications. Approximately 34% of applicants completed all required test components (N = 670). In 2024, the city received 4,115 total applications. Approximately 40% of applicants completed all exam components (N = 1,655).

As a part of the Citywide effort to boost police officer recruitment and retention, the PSCSC was asked to survey former police officer applicants who did not schedule and/or complete all required exam components. The goal of the survey was to allow candidates to share their experiences and provide feedback regarding factors that may have impacted their decision and/or ability to progress in the exam process.

Survey Group

The target group for the survey was individuals who applied for the police officer civil service exam but did not proceed with completing their exam. This group includes those who applied but did not schedule an exam, as well as those who scheduled an exam, but did not complete it. Because the survey was focused on applicants who did not proceed with the exam process, those who re-applied and successfully participated in future exams were excluded.

Survey Development

The Public Safety Exams Unit drafted the survey content in February 2024. The survey content was adapted from a 2022 Firefighter applicant survey that was developed for a similar purpose. The questions were customized to the entry level police officer exam and recruitment process. The primary goal during the survey development process was to design a measure that allowed detailed data to be collected while minimizing survey fatigue and time burden on respondents.

The Public Safety Exams Unit and PSCSC staff piloted and revised the survey in February 2024. The survey utilized branching logic and presented candidates with 13-15 questions. Candidates took an average of 6-7 minutes to complete the survey.

Confidentiality

In order to ensure respondent anonymity, individual identifying data will not be included in this report, and responses will only be reported in the aggregate. Candidates were notified in the survey invitation and survey introduction that their responses will be confidential and will have no impact on any active hiring process.

Data Collection & Response Rates

Survey responses were collected during three intervals in 2024. The first round of data collection took place between late February and early March 2024. 1,022 applicants were invited to participate in the February-March survey. This group represented those who applied in 2023 but did not schedule and/or complete their exam. Fifty (50) individuals from this group responded to the survey, with an overall response rate of 4.9%.

The second round of data collection took place in September 2024. 805 applicants were invited to participate in the September survey. This group represented those who applied within the first four exam cycles of 2024 (Jan – August) but did not schedule and/or complete their exam. Twenty-six (26) individuals from this group responded, with a response rate of 3.2%. The overall response rate from both data collection efforts was 3.2%.

The third round of data collection took place in December 2024 and 575 applicants were invited. This group represented those who applied within the fifth and sixth exam cycles of 2024 (August – October) but did not schedule and/or complete their exam. Twenty-one (21) individuals from this group responded, with a response rate of 3.7%. The overall response rate from all data collection efforts was 4%.

The survey invitation outlined the purpose of the survey, the information to be collected, the voluntary and confidential nature of the survey, the closing date for the survey, and contact information for questions and/or concerns. Candidates received email reminders to participate in the survey between the open and close dates.

The table below displays the demographics of the survey respondents across all rounds of data collection, as well as a comparison to the population of all entry police officer applicants from 2023 and 2024.

	Survey Respondents		2023 Applicants	2024 Applicants
Race	**n**	**%**	**%**	**%**
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0%	1.4%	1.5%
Asian or Pacific Islander	12	12.4%	15.3%	15.0%
Black	23	23.7%	25.3%	24.8%
Hispanic	16	16.5%	18.3%	19.8%
White	26	26.8%	35.3%	34.3%
Two or More Races	12	12.4%		
Other	2	2.0%		
Prefer Not to Respond	6	6.2%	4.4%	4.7%
Total	97	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%
Gender	**n**	**%**	**%**	**%**
Women	15	15.6%	13.6%	13.9%
Men	76	79.2%	84.6%	84.4%
Non-Binary	1	1.0%	0.6%	0.3%
Transgender	0	0.0%	0.3%	0.4%
Other	0	0.0%		
Prefer Not to Respond	5	4.2%	1.0%	0.9%
Total	97	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

**Note: the demographic categories of "Two or More Races" and "Other" are not available in the city's application system. As such, there are no comparison points in the application data for these categories.*

Limitations & Interpretation Notes

Caution should be taken while interpreting this data due to the extremely low response rate. When response rates are very small and samples are not representative, the data gathered are more susceptible to bias and the findings are less generalizable. Thus, it may be difficult to generate meaningful insights or robust conclusions based on this limited sample.

Low response rates were expected due to the nature of this feedback survey. We suspect motivation to participate in the survey was low among candidates who did not schedule or complete their exams. Though the survey only took approximately 7 minutes to complete, there was little incentive for the individuals in the targeted survey groups to provide feedback since many of them are no longer actively seeking law enforcement job opportunities at the city.

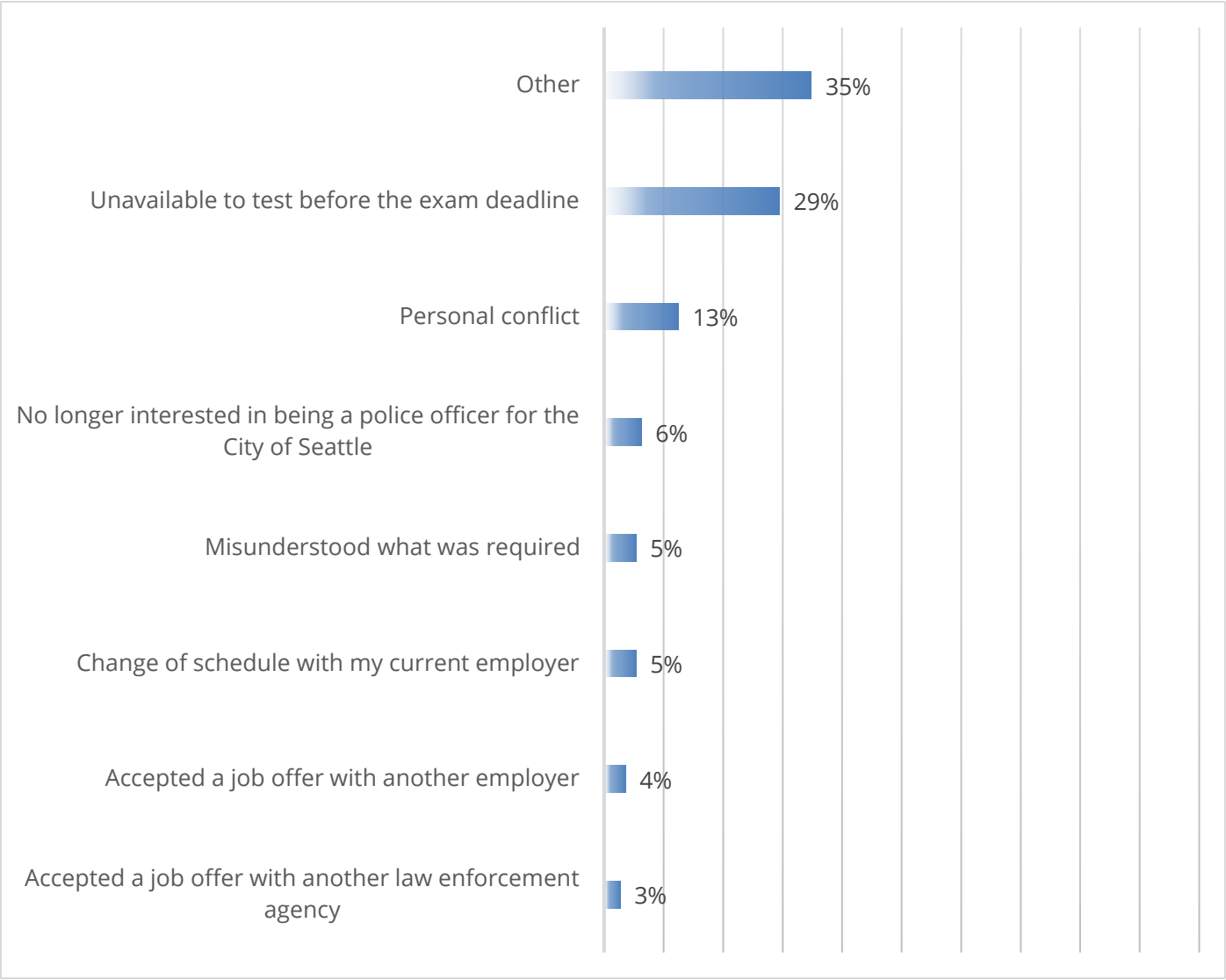
Likewise, it was expected that we would observe some level of nonresponse bias in the survey. According to OMB Standards and Guidelines for Statistical Surveys, "nonresponse bias occurs when the observed value deviates from the population parameter due to differences between respondents and nonrespondents." Specifically, we expected to see that candidates who had negative testing or application experiences would be more likely to complete the survey than candidates who had neutral or positive experiences. As a result, our data may not reflect the full range of candidate perceptions, nor the full range of factors that impacted candidates' decision and/or ability to complete exam process. Nonetheless, all feedback provided is taken into consideration in order to further understand the candidate experience and potential ways it can be improved.

The following pages detail the findings from this survey.

Survey Results

QUESTION 1:

Which of the statements below best describes why you applied to be a City of Seattle police officer but did not schedule and/or complete an exam? Check all that apply.



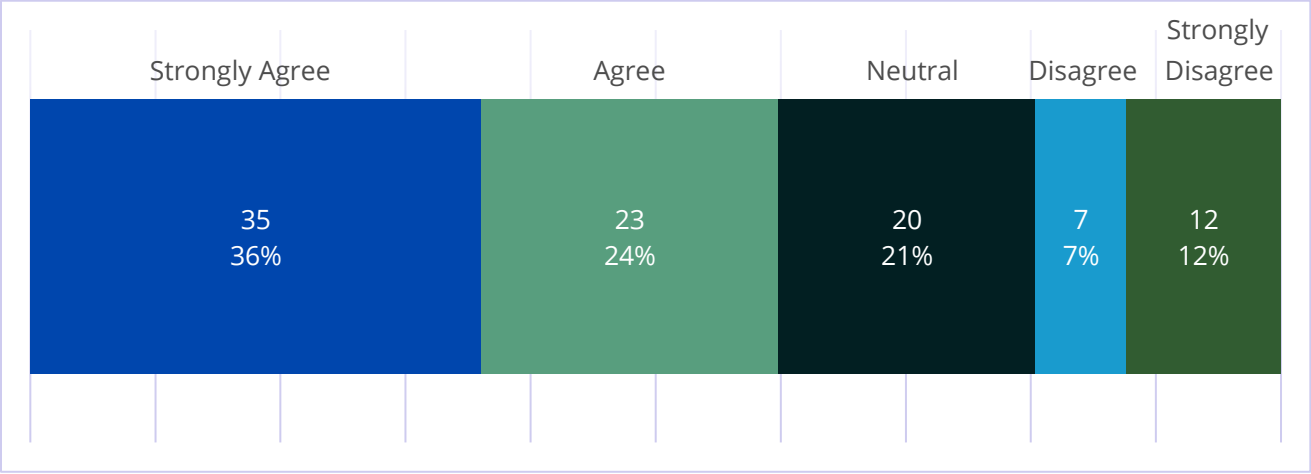
"Other" Response Themes:

- Remains interested/plans to test in the future
- Age or fitness concerns
- Confusion about exam and/or scheduling process
- Didn't receive candidate communications (potential email/spam issue)

QUESTION 2:

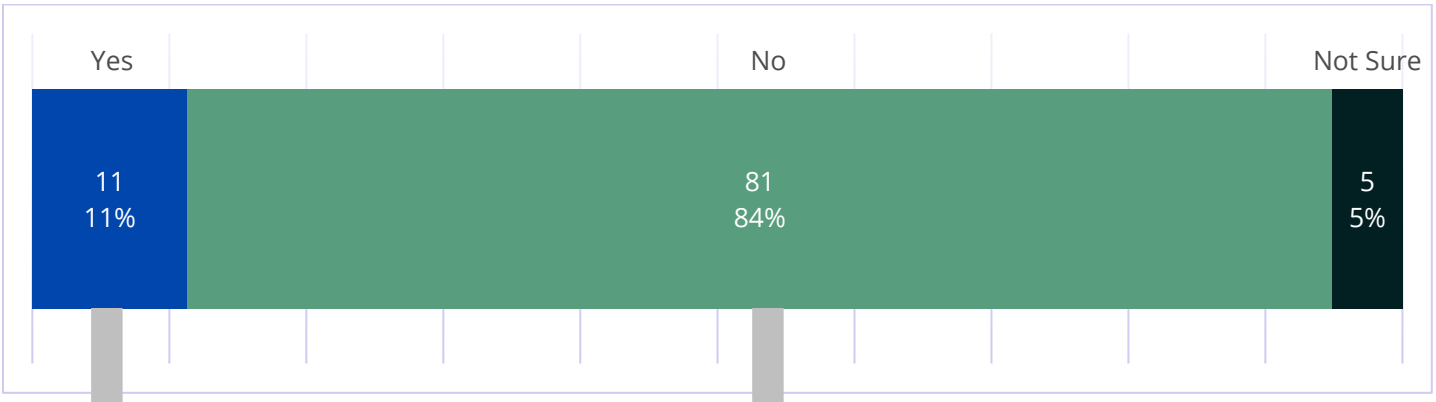
Information about the hiring process was communicated consistently throughout my involvement with the process.

Mean Rating	Std Dev
3.6 (“Agree” to “Neutral”)	1.4



QUESTION 3:

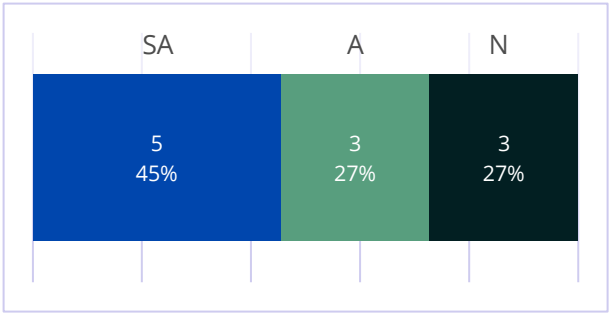
Did you participate in any Police Officer Applicant Workshops?



QUESTION 4:

The Police Officer Applicant Workshop was helpful to me as a police officer candidate.

Mean Rating	Std Dev
4.2 (“Agree”)	0.9

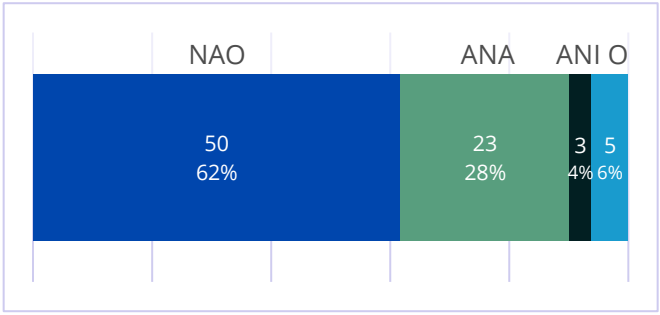


SA = Strongly Agree
A = Agree
N = Neutral
D = Disagree
SD = Strongly Disagree

No respondents selected “Disagree” or “Strongly Disagree” in response to this question.

QUESTION 5:

Which of the following best describes why you did not participate in the Police Officer Applicant Workshop?

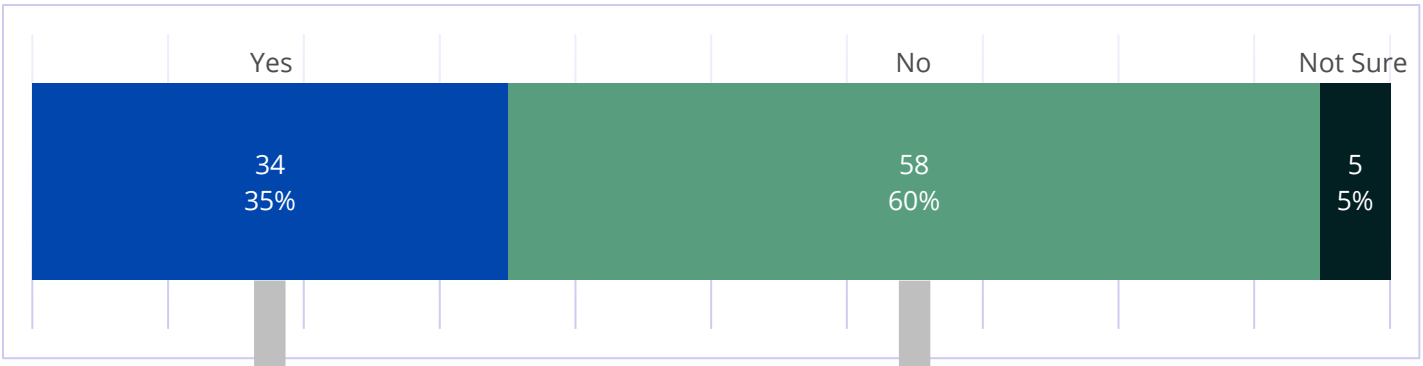


NAO = Not aware of opportunity
ANA = Aware, but not available
ANI = Aware, but not interested
O = Other

Note: Links to register for applicant workshops are sent to all candidates via email and text. Registration links are also available on the SPD website.

QUESTION 6:

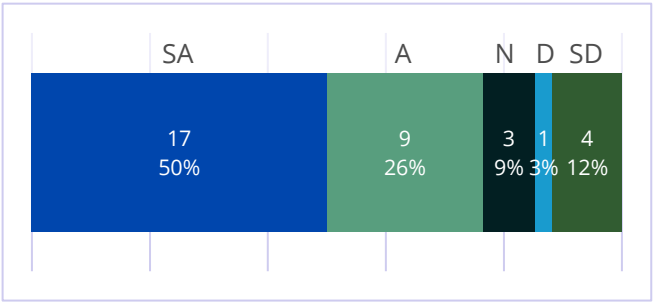
Did you speak with a recruiter or current Seattle Police Officer about the hiring process, the police academy, or other topics related to careers at SPD?



QUESTION 7:

Speaking with a recruiter or current Seattle Police Officer was helpful to me as a candidate.

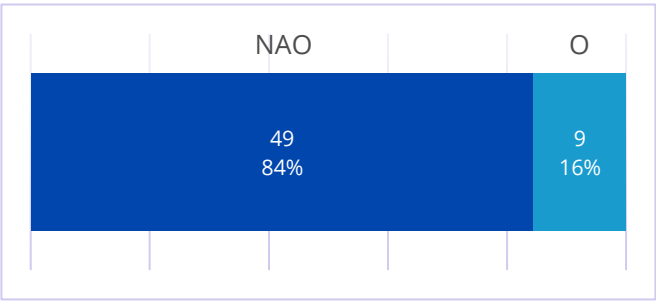
Mean Rating	Std Dev
4.0 (“Agree”)	1.3



SA = Strongly Agree
A = Agree
N = Neutral
D = Disagree
SD = Strongly Disagree

QUESTION 8:

Which of the following best describes why you didn't speak with a recruiter or current Seattle Police Officer about the hiring process, the police academy, or other topics relating to careers at SPD?



NAO = Not aware of opportunity
ANA = Aware, but not available
ANI = Aware, but not interested
O = Other

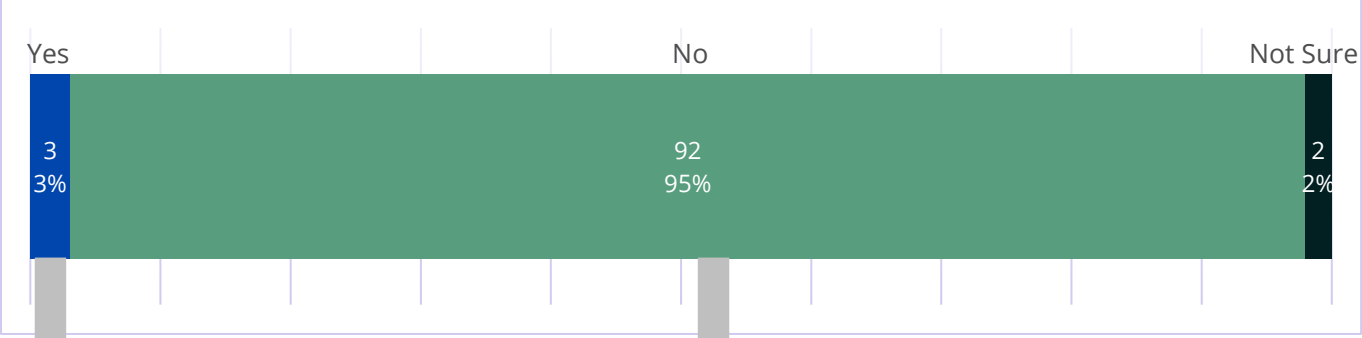
“Other” Response Themes:

- Did not feel it was necessary

Note: Links to speak with a recruiter are located in the job bulletin, the SPD website, and all email communications to candidates. Additionally, as of March 2024, all applicants are prompted to “opt in” to speak with a recruiter at the time of application. The names of all candidates who opted in are shared with SPD weekly.

QUESTION 9:

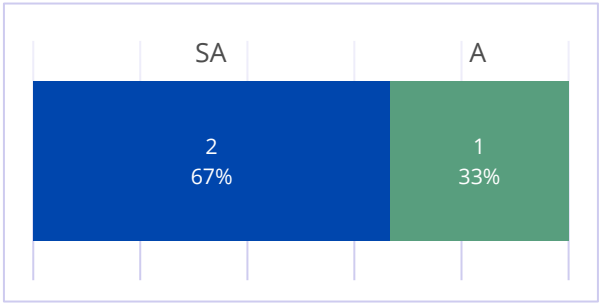
Did you participate in a ride along with the Seattle Police Department?



QUESTION 10:

Participating in a ride along was helpful to me as a candidate.

Mean Rating	Std Dev
4.7 ("Strongly Agree")	0.6

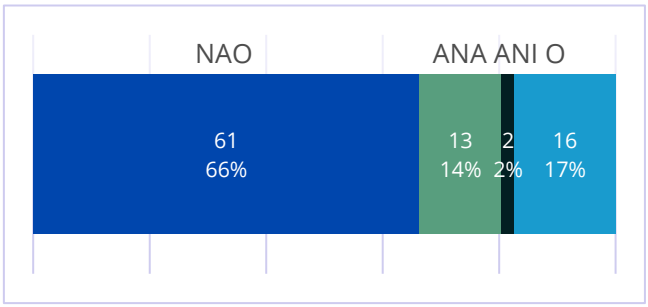


SA = Strongly Agree
A = Agree
N = Neutral
D = Disagree
SD = Strongly Disagree

No respondents selected "Neutral", "Disagree", or "Strongly Disagree" in response to this question.

QUESTION 11:

Which of the following best describes the reason why you did not participate in a ride along?



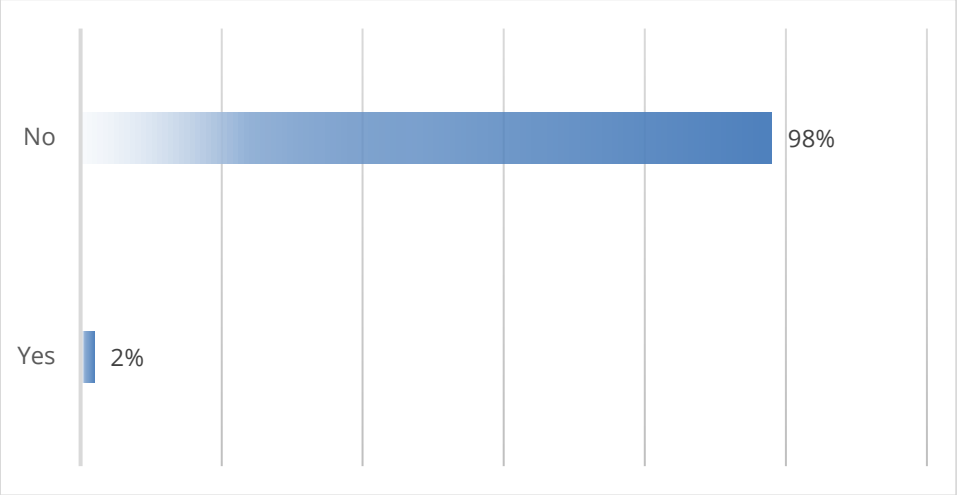
NAO = Not aware of opportunity
ANA = Aware, but not available
ANI = Aware, but not interested
O = Other

"Other" Response Themes:

- Live out of state

QUESTION 12:

Did you participate in any other police officer applicant resources or events that were not listed in the previous questions?

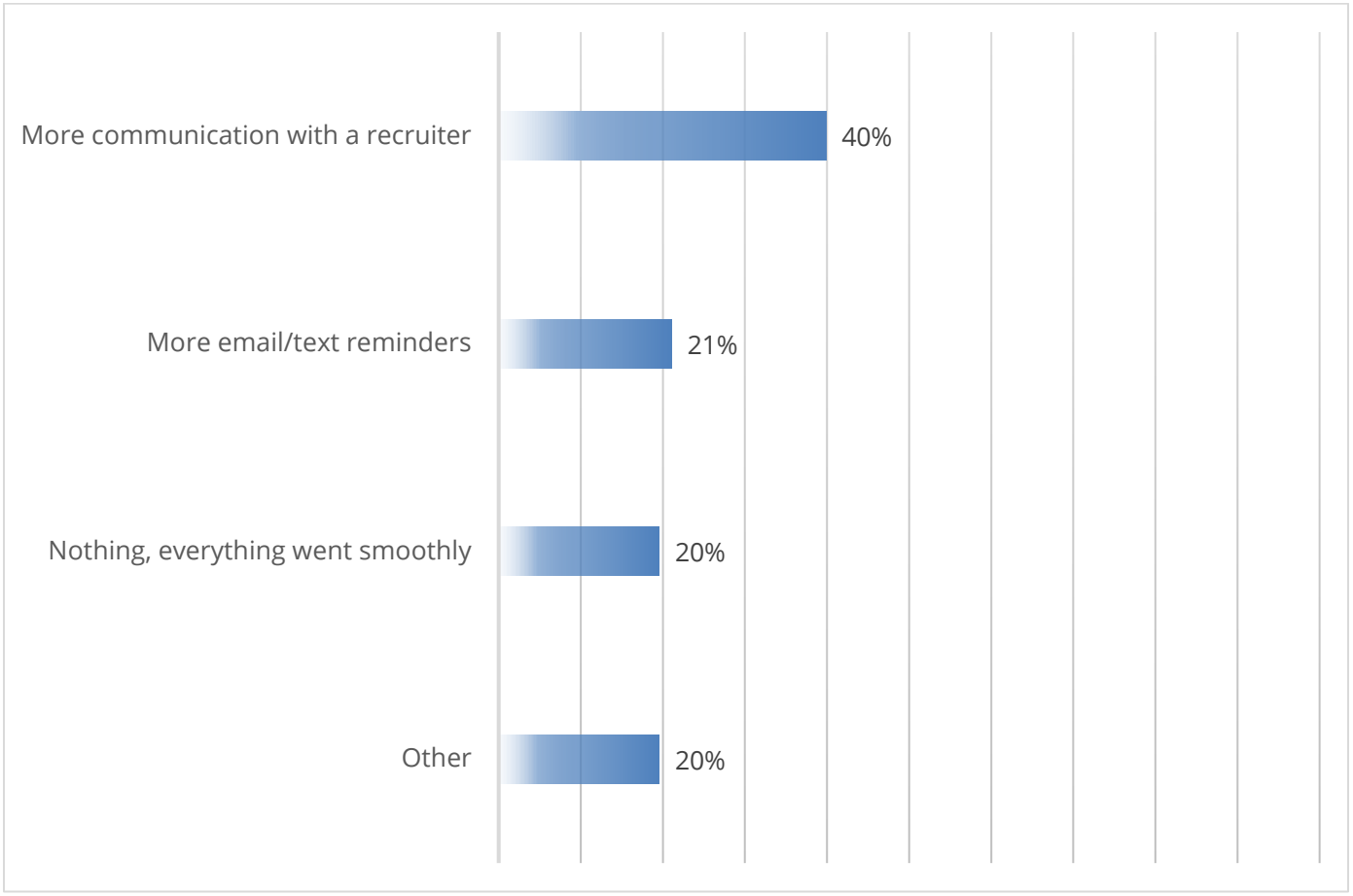


Other Resource Listed:

Hiring events with other police agencies

QUESTION 13:

What would make the hiring process better? Check all that apply.

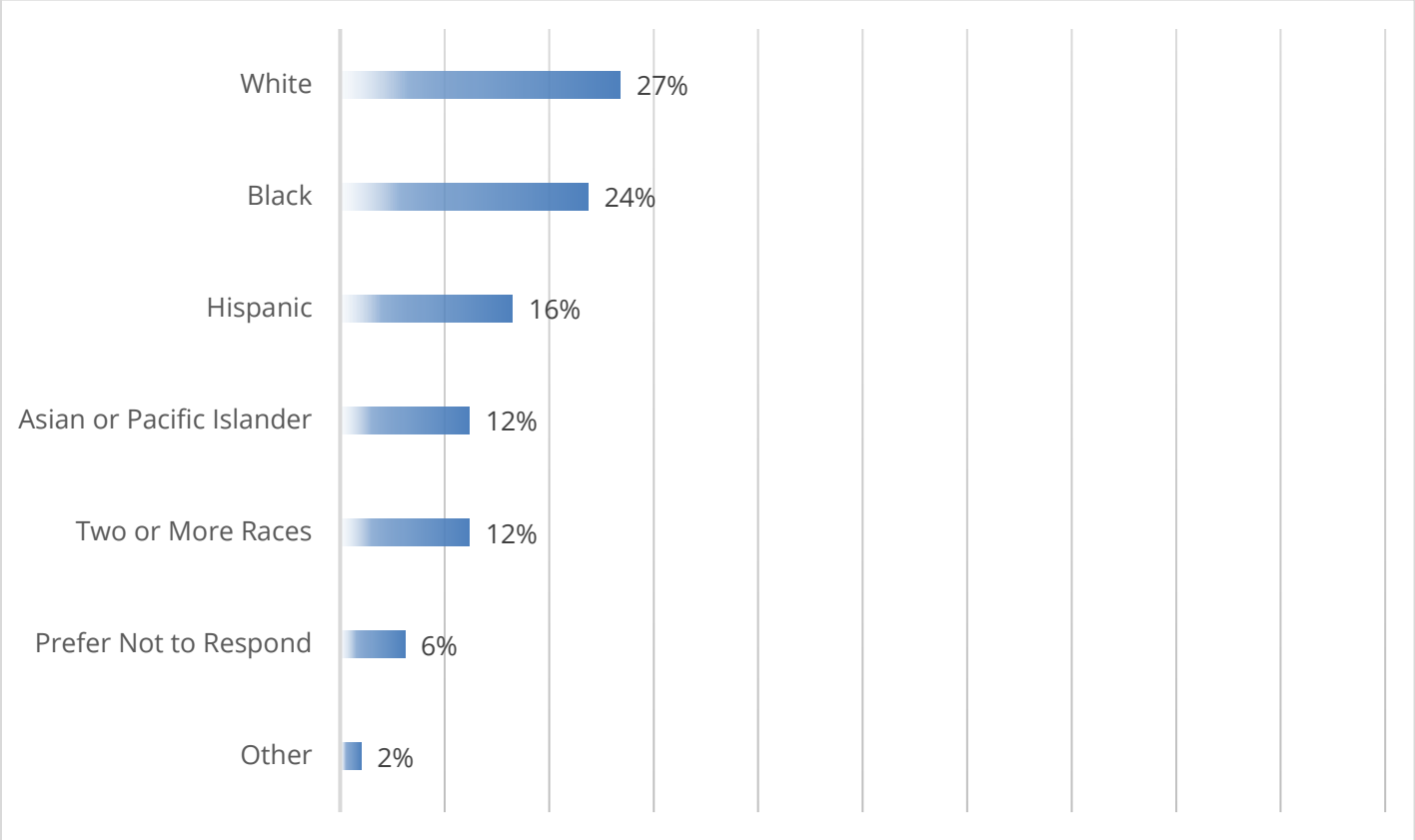


"Other" Response Themes:

- Increased communication/customer service

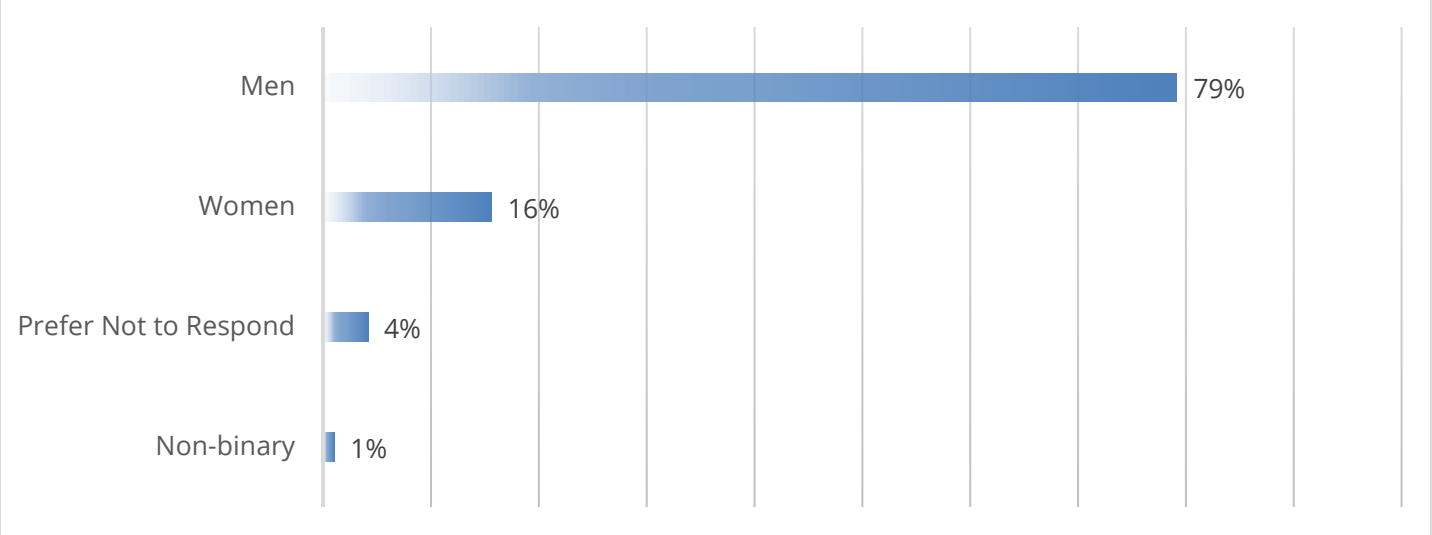
QUESTION 14:

Respondent Race



QUESTION 15:

Respondent Gender



Conclusion/Recommendations

Limited Data

Due to low survey response rates, caution should be taken in generalizing the findings. When the sample size is limited, the results may not reflect the full range of candidate experiences, making it difficult to develop robust conclusions.

Feedback on Candidate Resources

- Candidates generally agreed that participating in the police applicant workshops and speaking with a recruiter was helpful.
- Candidates strongly agreed that participating in a ride along was helpful. This is consistent with extant research on the benefits of realistic job previews.
- Many respondents reported that they did not participate in a ride along because they live out of state. Out of state applicants may benefit from virtual ride alongs or other technology-based realistic job previews. (Samples: Tallahassee PD Live Virtual Ride Along Program, Pierce County Pre-Recorded Virtual Ride Along Video)

Improvement Opportunities

- "Unavailable to test before the exam deadline" was one of the most prevalent reasons why respondents did not schedule and/or complete their exams (29%, N = 30). This finding suggests that some candidates may benefit from the city's recent shit to an open, continuous exam process in which candidates can test at their convenience, without "hard and fast" testing deadlines throughout the year. However, it is not guaranteed that an open continuous exam process will result in increased eligible candidates or hires, and the PSCSC will continue to monitor and report the impacts of this change.
- "More communication with a recruiter" was the most prevalent response to how respondents would improve the hiring process (40%, N = 53). This finding lends support to recently implemented and pending process improvements for candidate communications.
- Applicants may also benefit from the following additional awareness of police applicant workshops and ride along opportunities.

Attachment F

Background Process Timelines

January 2025

Metric	Notes
Average time to complete the background process * Data obtained from NEOGOV	**Background Process Timelines**: • **SPD Background Investigations Detectives** ○ From Eligibility List to Offer Letter **(October - December 2024) *** ○ Average time to complete: 140 days ▪ Steps included in the completion process: • Background Investigation • Criminal history check • Polygraph examination • Medical examination • Psychological Evaluation ○ Upstaffing of the SPD Background Investigations Team is in process to further improve background timelines • Public Safety Testing (PST) Investigation Services ○ In September 2024, SPD began employing PST to assist with background investigations. ○ PST's completion timeline for each preliminary investigation ranges between two (2) and three (3) weeks. After the preliminary investigation file is returned to SPD, Background Investigations Detectives spend approximately four (4) weeks conducting criminal history checks, interviews and reference checks (as necessary), and a quality control assessment of the investigation. ○ The partnership with PST has yielded increased processing capacity of background investigations **Historical Background Process Timelines**: • **SPD Background Investigations Detectives** ○ From Eligibility List to Offer Letter **(July - October 2024) *** ○ Average time to complete: 140 days ○ From Eligibility List to Offer Letter **(January - July 2024) *** ○ Average time to complete: 142 days ○ From Eligibility List to Offer Letter **(Calendar year 2023) *** ○ Average time to complete: 174 days *Data obtained from NEOGOV

Attachment G

Summary of Results from Officer Exit Interviews and Surveys

January 2025

Metric	Notes
Officer Exit Interview Data **(October – December 2024)**	The SPD Human Resources Bureau Exit Interview is a series of pre-defined questions; participation in the survey instrument is voluntary. The responses below were compiled from six (6) exit interviews received between October - December 2024. Three (3) employees were retiring; three (3) were resigning. **Reason for leaving:** • "To enjoy retirement." • "Career path change." • "I am pursuing an alternate career path for the time being. It is a position that I would like to do while I am younger. There are no negative reasons from the Department that prompted this." • "Accepted a job with another agency." • "Family - closer commute, be closer to home." • "Age." **Interest in working for SPD again in the future:** • "I would like to keep the door open for SPD, if permitted. I believe that there are many good officers and staff in the Department." • "No." **What employees enjoyed most about working at SPD and/or in their position:** • "I enjoyed the mixture of dynamic challenges this career provided." • "I enjoyed the level of dedication of the training staff, and the individual attention that they gave students." • "The challenge, the people, the opportunity." • "The quality of training." • "My fellow Officers." **What employees enjoyed least about working at SPD and/or in their position:** • "I strongly disliked having to deal with other people's bodily fluids." • "Politics and pandering to individuals that did not have the best interest of the majority of the citizens." • "The pressure it put on my wife because of the commute."

	• "The politics." • "I do not believe that I was employed long enough to speak to the negative aspects of SPD." **Factors with a positive effect on morale in the Department:** • "I was continually impressed by the quality of Seattle's Police Officers and civilian staff." • "I believe that the supervisors had a positive effect on morale." • "The potential impact of new City Council." • "Dedication to Department from personnel." **Factors with a negative effect on morale in the Department:** • "City politics." • "Past City Council and the underfunding of police." • "Low number in personnel." • "I do not believe that I was employed long enough to speak to the negative aspects of SPD." **Suggestions for improving the job and/or department:** • "I would suggest developing a system where squads can attend in-service training together." • "I believe keeping the same quality of training staff for the coming years will have a positive impact." • "Find a sane middle-ground and stick to the facts, true cause, and integrity in all that you do and/or decide." • "N/A" **Did you have the necessary equipment to successfully complete your job:** • "Yes." **Professional development opportunities:** • "Yes." • "Yes, there were always opportunities for extra training in my experience." • "I was afforded professional development for a majority of my career. Unfortunately, due to staffing shortages I don't believe there is as much of those opportunities available." • "Yes, there were sufficient." **Feelings about whether the salary was competitive:** • "Yes." • "Yes, it is competitive."

	Opportunities to develop relationships with your peers and supervisors: • "Yes." • "Yes, I had sufficient opportunity." **Additional comments:** • "I had a great career with the SPD, and I would have stayed a few years longer if the atmosphere of the city was different, and if the leadership had less drama."
Retention Strategies and Improvement Opportunities	Retention strategies and improvement opportunities suggested by available Exit Interview data: • Visible and continued show of support from City Council • Maintaining high supervisory standards • Continued focus on recruiting high-quality, committed employees • Maintaining high standards within SPD training • Expanded leadership training Department wide • Consistent show of support from SPD command staff • Availability of Mentorship programs (to promote employee/leadership development) • Timely settlement of collective bargain agreements • Ensuring competitive wages • Flexible shift options to mitigate the Seattle-area commute For retention strategies and improvement opportunities suggested by the PSCSC's Police Officer Applicant Exam Survey data, see the "Conclusion/Recommendations" section of Attachment E.